NCE EXAM PREP

Practice Exam 04

Domain 4

Provision of Counseling Interventions

34 Practice Questions | 45 minutes

A, B, C answer choices

Answer Key and Explanations included

> **Instructions.** Select the single best answer for each question. Record your answers separately. This domain practice set is drawn from Full-Length Practice Exam 01. Use the suggested 45-minute practice timer. Do not consult Part B until you complete Part A. These domain timings are editorial practice allocations, not official NBCC section limits.

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PART A — QUESTIONS

Choose one answer (A, B, or C) per question.

Question 1

> A client with chronic pain alternates between doing many household tasks on a low-pain day and being unable to function for several days afterward. The client values contributing at home and wants a more sustainable pattern.

Which intervention best matches the client's goal?

A) Collaboratively establish paced, graded activity with planned rest before symptoms sharply increase.

B) Encourage the client to complete as much as possible on low-pain days to preserve independence.

C) Recommend avoiding household activity until pain is consistently minimal.

Question 2

> In the third session of a new interpersonal group, one member speaks at length whenever silence occurs. Several members have stopped trying to enter the conversation and exchange frustrated looks.

What is the leader's best intervention?

A) Respectfully interrupt, describe the participation pattern, and invite the group to examine how it is affecting them.

B) Allow the member to continue because early group cohesion depends on avoiding direct feedback.

C) Establish a fixed time limit for every member without discussing the reactions already occurring in the group.

Question 3

> A client receives counseling by telephone, has limited access to printed materials, and says lengthy written worksheets are difficult to understand. The counselor wants to teach a cognitive coping skill.

How should the counselor adapt the intervention?

A) Email the standard worksheet and spend the next session reading every instruction aloud.

B) Teach one step verbally with a concrete example, practice it together, and use teach-back to check understanding.

C) Postpone skills training until in-person services and complete written materials are available.

Question 4

> In a multicultural group, one member values direct disagreement, while another experiences direct challenge as disrespectful and withdraws. Other members begin taking sides about the “right” way to communicate.

What should the group counselor do?

A) Adopt the more direct style because open disagreement produces deeper group work.

B) Name the differing communication meanings and help the group develop norms that allow both engagement and respect.

C) Stop all disagreement until members have developed enough trust to communicate in the same way.

Question 5

> A high school student is acutely overwhelmed after witnessing a serious accident. School crisis staff have established that the student is physically safe and has no current intent to harm self or others. The student says, “Everything is happening at once. I can’t think.”

Which intervention is most appropriate at this point?

A) Ask the student to give a complete chronological account so the memory can be processed accurately.

B) Help the student orient to the present, identify one immediate need, and take one manageable step at a time.

C) Explain the diagnostic criteria for acute stress disorder so the student can monitor symptoms.

Question 6

> A graduate student seeks help for social anxiety. She values family interdependence and says her most important goal is participating more comfortably at extended-family gatherings, not becoming broadly outgoing. She is willing to try gradual exposure.

How should the counselor apply exposure work most responsively?

A) Use a standard hierarchy focused on speaking to strangers because it offers the broadest practice.

B) Collaboratively build a hierarchy around interactions the client identifies as meaningful at family gatherings.

C) Begin with the largest family event so improvement can occur before avoidance becomes more established.

Question 7

> A client reports repeated disability-related comments from coworkers. The client wants help responding but says, “I’m tired of being told to just think more positively.”

Which intervention best integrates validation and problem solving?

A) Acknowledge the harm, identify what is and is not within the client’s control, and rehearse a response the client chooses.

B) Use cognitive restructuring to show that coworkers’ comments may have been misunderstood.

C) Encourage immediate formal action because self-advocacy requires directly challenging discrimination.

Question 8

> During a telehealth crisis session, a distressed client becomes more agitated each time the video freezes and says, “I can’t keep repeating myself.” The counselor had confirmed the client’s location and backup telephone number at the start of the session.

What should the counselor do next?

A) Continue by video and ask the client to summarize the story in shorter statements.

B) End the session and send coping resources electronically to avoid further frustration.

C) Acknowledge the added frustration, offer to switch to the agreed telephone backup, and reestablish a manageable pace.

Question 9

> A client says punctuality is essential to being dependable but has arrived more than 20 minutes late for the last three sessions. The client has not mentioned the pattern.

Which counselor response is the most effective use of confrontation?

A) “You are not as dependable as you believe, because you repeatedly arrive late.”

B) “You value punctuality, and I’ve noticed you have arrived late recently. How do you understand that difference?”

C) “I will overlook the late arrivals because confronting them could weaken our relationship.”

Question 10

> A Black client tells a White counselor, “When I mentioned racism at work, you focused on my communication style. I don’t think you understand what I’m dealing with.”

Which response is most likely to begin repairing the alliance?

A) “I treat every workplace conflict the same way, regardless of anyone’s racial background.”

B) “I hear that my response missed the role of racism and left you feeling misunderstood. Would you tell me more about the impact?”

C) “I may not fully understand, so it would be better for us to avoid interpreting the event until I learn more about your culture.”

Question 11

> A college athlete wants to stop sending hostile messages during conflicts. The client recognizes tension in the jaw and hands just before acting and likes practicing skills through drills rather than discussion alone.

Which in-session intervention is the best fit?

A) Rehearse noticing the physical cues, taking a timed pause, and composing a response only after arousal decreases.

B) Explore childhood experiences associated with anger without practicing a behavioral alternative yet.

C) Advise the client to suppress angry thoughts whenever physical tension begins.

Question 12

A client experiencing intense anxiety agrees to try paced breathing. After two cycles, the client says, “This is making me dizzy,” and appears more frightened. The client remains able to communicate and is physically safe.

How should the counselor respond?

A) Encourage several more cycles because initial discomfort is expected when learning the skill.

B) Pause the breathing exercise, shift to an external grounding method, and monitor the client’s response.

C) Explain that dizziness is caused by anxiety and ask the client to disregard it while continuing.

Question 13

Two members of an outpatient group discover that they work in the same large organization. Neither supervises the other, but both worry about encountering each other at work.

What is the group leader’s best response?

A) Require one member to transfer to another group to eliminate any possibility of contact.

B) Ask both members to tell the group which department they work in so risks can be evaluated openly.

C) Review confidentiality limits and help the members develop a mutually acceptable plan for incidental contact.

Question 14

A client says a mindfulness exercise feels inconsistent with the client’s religious beliefs and worries that continuing it would be disrespectful to their faith.

What is the counselor’s most culturally responsive next step?

A) Explain that mindfulness is a clinical exercise rather than a religious practice and continue using it.

B) Discontinue all attention-based exercises because the client’s concern makes them inappropriate.

C) Explore the client’s concern and collaborate on an acceptable practice, such as faith-consistent reflection or sensory grounding.

Question 15

During family counseling, two parents argue and each asks their 14-year-old, “Tell the counselor who is right.” The adolescent looks down and says, “I don’t want to choose.”

What should the counselor do?

A) Ask the adolescent to describe each parent’s strongest argument so the family can feel equally represented.

B) Remove the adolescent from the referee role and facilitate direct communication between the parents.

C) Invite the adolescent to leave the room while the counselor determines which parent’s position is more reasonable.

Question 16

Which intervention best fits a client who recognizes consequences of substance use but remains uncertain about making a change?

A) Explore the client's own reasons for and against change while supporting autonomy.

B) Develop a detailed abstinence schedule and ask the client to commit to it immediately.

C) Challenge each statement favoring continued use until the client accepts the need to change.

Question 17

> A Deaf client uses a qualified American Sign Language interpreter during counseling. The counselor realizes that most questions and eye contact have been directed toward the interpreter rather than the client.

What adjustment is most appropriate?

A) Address and look toward the client while allowing the interpreter to facilitate communication.

B) Continue addressing the interpreter because the interpreter is responsible for conveying the meaning accurately.

C) Alternate questions between the client and interpreter so both have equal roles in the counseling dialogue.

Question 18

> A long-term client invites the counselor to attend the client's graduation, saying, "You're the reason I made it." The counselor's role and agency boundaries make attendance inappropriate.

What is the most therapeutic response?

A) Acknowledge the significance of the invitation, explore what attendance would represent, and discuss an appropriate way to honor the milestone in counseling.

B) Decline briefly without further discussion so the professional boundary is not made emotionally confusing.

C) Accept the invitation because attending a public ceremony does not create a meaningful boundary concern.

Question 19

When is a closed question generally most useful during a counseling interview?

A) When clarifying a specific fact after the client has had room to describe the experience.

B) When encouraging the client to discover an unrecognized personal meaning.

C) When demonstrating empathy for an emotionally complex experience.

Question 20

> In a counseling group, Malik describes feeling ashamed after losing his job. Another member quickly lists job-search strategies. Malik becomes quiet, looks down, and pulls his chair back.

What is the group counselor's best intervention?

A) Ask the advice-giving member to finish the list so Malik can decide which suggestions are useful.

B) Shift the discussion to another member who has also experienced unemployment.

C) Pause the advice and invite Malik to describe what happened for him as the group responded.

Question 21

> While describing the death of a close friend, a client stops speaking and begins to cry. After several seconds, the client remains oriented, takes a slow breath, and looks toward the counselor.

What is the counselor's best immediate response?

A) Remain quietly attentive and allow the client space to continue when ready.

B) Ask a series of factual questions about the friend to help the client regain composure.

C) Reassure the client that grief becomes easier with time and move to coping strategies.

Question 22

> A young adult with a recently acquired mobility impairment feels anxious about requesting an accessible workspace. The client wants to speak for themself in an upcoming meeting but does not know how to begin.

Which counseling intervention best promotes client empowerment?

A) Help the client choose the request, role-play the conversation, and refine wording based on the client's feedback.

B) Contact the employer for the client because professional advocacy is more effective than self-advocacy.

C) Provide a script for the client to memorize exactly so anxiety does not interfere with the meeting.

Question 23

> After a neighborhood fire, a parent asks how to explain the event to an 8-year-old who repeatedly asks whether another fire will happen. The child is safe and is showing no severe impairment.

Which guidance is most appropriate?

A) Avoid discussing the fire unless the child raises it, because explanations can reinforce fear.

B) Give the child detailed information about fire probability so the child can evaluate the actual risk.

C) Use simple truthful language, describe current safety routines, practice a coping skill, and check what the child understood.

Question 24

> After medical causes have been ruled out, a college student who recently experienced a first panic episode says, “My racing heart means I’m losing control.” The student is calm enough to talk and asks what happened.

Which counselor response best combines psychoeducation with skill development?

A) Explain the body’s alarm response in plain language, then rehearse a brief grounding strategy and ask the student to describe its effect.

B) Provide a handout on panic symptoms and ask the student to read it before the next counseling appointment.

C) Emphasize that the episode was harmless and advise the student to ignore similar physical sensations in the future.

Question 25

> During a couple session, each partner gives a conflicting account of a recent argument and repeatedly interrupts to correct the other. Both insist that the counselor decide who remembers the event accurately.

Which intervention best serves the counseling process?

A) Compare the details of both accounts and identify which partner provides the more consistent version.

B) Structure equal speaking turns and reflect the pursue-withdraw pattern occurring between the partners.

C) Ask each partner to submit a written account after the session so the counselor can determine what happened.

Question 26

> A client with insomnia works rotating shifts and lives in a multigenerational household where evening time together is highly valued. A standard fixed bedtime recommendation has not been feasible.

What is the counselor’s best intervention adjustment?

A) Emphasize that evidence-based sleep routines require the client to prioritize a fixed bedtime over family activities.

B) Collaborate on consistent sleep cues and stimulus-control practices that can flex with shifts and preserve valued family time.

C) Stop using behavioral sleep strategies because the client’s schedule prevents adequate treatment adherence.

Question 27

What is the primary therapeutic purpose of a counselor’s summary near the end of a session?

A) To introduce new interpretations that the client can consider between sessions.

B) To document every topic discussed so no session content is omitted.

C) To integrate major themes, check shared understanding, and support continuity.

Question 28

> In a video session, a client says, “Everything is fine,” while looking away, speaking more softly, and becoming unusually still. The counselor cannot tell whether the behavior reflects emotion, distraction, or a poor connection.

What is the counselor’s best response?

A) Interpret the behavior as avoidance and ask why the client is withholding emotion.

B) Accept the verbal statement because nonverbal behavior is unreliable in telehealth.

C) Describe the observable change without assigning meaning and invite the client to clarify what is happening.

Question 29

> In family counseling, the parents say major decisions traditionally include a respected grandparent. Their 16-year-old asks to discuss some concerns without that grandparent present. All family members are willing to discuss how sessions will be structured.

How should the counselor proceed most responsively?

A) Exclude the grandparent because adolescent privacy should always override family decision-making traditions.

B) Include the grandparent in every session because the parents have defined the family’s cultural practice.

C) Explore what the grandparent’s involvement and the adolescent’s privacy mean to each person, then negotiate roles and session boundaries.

Question 30

> During a fourth session, a client says, “You keep moving me to the next topic before I finish. I leave feeling unheard.” The counselor notices an urge to explain that session time is limited.

Which response would best address the interaction at this moment?

A) “I appreciate you telling me. I may have been moving too quickly; can we look at when you felt cut off and what you needed from me?”

B) “Our time is limited, so I sometimes have to redirect us to cover everything in your treatment plan.”

C) “Let’s set that concern aside for now and return to the situation you were describing at work.”

Question 31

> A community counseling client has just received an eviction notice. The client is pacing, speaking loudly, and saying, “No one will help me, so stop asking questions.” The counselor has already established that the client has no weapon and is not threatening self-harm or harm to others.

Which in-session response is most likely to reduce escalation?

A) Present a detailed list of housing programs so the client can immediately choose among them.

B) Use a calm voice, acknowledge the client’s overwhelm, and offer a choice between sitting or continuing to walk while talking.

C) Explain that productive counseling requires the client to lower their voice before the session can continue.

Question 32

> A client with depression agreed to complete five behavioral activation activities but completed none. The client says, “The list looked impossible when I got home, so I stayed in bed.”

How should the counselor respond when continuing this intervention?

A) Keep the same assignment for another week so the client has enough time to demonstrate commitment.

B) Replace behavioral activation with cognitive restructuring because noncompletion shows the method is ineffective.

C) Explore the barriers and collaboratively choose one small, personally meaningful activity with a specific time.

Question 33

> During an imagery exercise related to a traumatic memory, a client becomes still, stops responding to the counselor’s questions, and appears disoriented. The client had previously agreed on a signal for pausing the exercise.

What should the counselor do now?

A) Continue the imagery at a slower pace so the client can complete the therapeutic task.

B) Ask the client to interpret the meaning of becoming still before changing the intervention.

C) Stop the imagery and use the agreed pause procedure to support present-moment orientation.

Question 34

Which counselor statement is the clearest example of immediacy?

A) “You felt dismissed when your supervisor changed the subject yesterday.”

B) “What possibilities have you considered for responding to your supervisor?”

C) “As we discuss this, I notice you look away each time I offer an observation. What is happening between us right now?”

PART B — ANSWER KEY AND EXPLANATIONS

Answers match the numbered items in Part A.

Question 1 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Collaboratively establish paced, graded activity with planned rest before symptoms sharply increase.

Explanation: Pacing interrupts the boom-and-bust cycle by supporting sustainable participation rather than maximizing activity only when symptoms are low. Complete avoidance can reduce functioning, while overactivity on a good day is the pattern already contributing to prolonged setbacks.

Question 2 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Respectfully interrupt, describe the participation pattern, and invite the group to examine how it is affecting them.

Explanation: The leader both blocks monopolizing and turns the observable pattern into therapeutic group work. A rule imposed without processing may create compliance, but it would miss members' current reactions and the opportunity for interpersonal learning.

Question 3 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Teach one step verbally with a concrete example, practice it together, and use teach-back to check understanding.

Explanation: Breaking the skill into an accessible spoken step, practicing it, and checking learning adapts delivery without withholding the intervention. Reading a complex worksheet aloud preserves much of the original barrier, and waiting for ideal service conditions unnecessarily delays care.

Question 4 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Name the differing communication meanings and help the group develop norms that allow both engagement and respect.

Explanation: The counselor makes cultural and interpersonal meanings discussable without declaring one communication style superior. Collaborative norms can expand members' options while preserving safety; suppressing disagreement would also suppress an important source of group learning.

Question 5 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Help the student orient to the present, identify one immediate need, and take one manageable step at a time.

Explanation: Acute overwhelm calls for stabilization, reduced cognitive demand, and concrete, manageable action. A detailed retelling can increase arousal, while diagnostic education is unlikely to be useful until the student can process more information.

Question 6 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Collaboratively build a hierarchy around interactions the client identifies as meaningful at family gatherings.

Explanation: Exposure is most relevant when it targets situations connected to the client's own goals and values. A collaboratively designed hierarchy can retain the effective mechanism of gradual exposure without imposing an individualistic goal of becoming broadly outgoing.

Question 7 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Acknowledge the harm, identify what is and is not within the client's control, and rehearse a response the client chooses.

Explanation: This intervention validates the discriminatory context while building a concrete, client-directed coping and advocacy skill. Reframing the comments as a possible misunderstanding risks invalidation, and directing immediate formal action overrides the client's autonomy.

Question 8 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Acknowledge the added frustration, offer to switch to the agreed telephone backup, and reestablish a manageable pace.

Explanation: The counselor addresses the technological source of escalation, validates its effect, and uses the previously established backup to preserve continuity. Requiring more repetition over an unstable connection would add burden, and ending the session prematurely would reduce support during distress.

Question 9 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: "You value punctuality, and I've noticed you have arrived late recently. How do you understand that difference?"

Explanation: Effective confrontation presents a discrepancy tentatively and invites the client to make meaning of it. Labeling the client as undependable is judgmental, while ignoring the pattern sacrifices potentially useful therapeutic information.

Question 10 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: "I hear that my response missed the role of racism and left you feeling misunderstood. Would you tell me more about the impact?"

Explanation: The counselor names the missed context, takes responsibility for the impact, and invites the client's perspective, all of which can support alliance repair. Claiming identical treatment for every conflict minimizes the client's report and the sociocultural meaning of the event.

Question 11 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Rehearse noticing the physical cues, taking a timed pause, and composing a response only after arousal decreases.

Explanation: This intervention uses the client's identified warning signs and preferred active learning style to build a concrete interruption-and-response sequence. Insight exploration alone does not meet the immediate skill goal, and thought suppression is unlikely to produce reliable regulation.

Question 12 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Pause the breathing exercise, shift to an external grounding method, and monitor the client's response.

Explanation: The client reports worsening symptoms, so the counselor should stop the aggravating technique, offer a lower-risk alternative, and assess its effect. Insisting on continued practice would disregard direct feedback and could further associate coping practice with loss of control.

Question 13 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Review confidentiality limits and help the members develop a mutually acceptable plan for incidental contact.

Explanation: The leader responds to a realistic boundary concern through informed discussion and collaborative planning. Automatic transfer is disproportionate to the facts, and requiring workplace details would add disclosure that is not necessary to address the concern.

Question 14 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Explore the client's concern and collaborate on an acceptable practice, such as faith-consistent reflection or sensory grounding.

Explanation: Culturally responsive intervention begins with curiosity about the client's meaning and preserves choice while seeking a workable therapeutic process. Simply relabeling mindfulness as clinical dismisses the concern, whereas eliminating every attention-based option is unnecessarily rigid.

Question 15 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Remove the adolescent from the referee role and facilitate direct communication between the parents.

Explanation: Redirecting the parents to speak with each other interrupts triangulation and protects the adolescent from being recruited into the dispute. Asking the adolescent to compare the arguments would strengthen the very role the adolescent is resisting.

Question 16 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Explore the client's own reasons for and against change while supporting autonomy.

Explanation: A client who sees consequences but remains uncertain is expressing ambivalence, so an autonomy-supportive exploration can strengthen self-motivated change. Premature action planning or argumentative challenge is likely to evoke resistance rather than resolve uncertainty.

Question 17 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Address and look toward the client while allowing the interpreter to facilitate communication.

Explanation: The counselor should maintain the therapeutic relationship directly with the client while the interpreter supports communication access. Treating the interpreter as the primary conversational partner can marginalize the client and weaken engagement.

Question 18 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Acknowledge the significance of the invitation, explore what attendance would represent, and discuss an appropriate way to honor the milestone in counseling.

Explanation: The counselor maintains the stated boundary while treating the invitation as meaningful clinical material rather than merely rejecting it. Acceptance would conflict with the established role, while a brief refusal could overlook attachment, gratitude, and transition themes.

Question 19 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: When clarifying a specific fact after the client has had room to describe the experience.

Explanation: Closed questions are useful for obtaining or confirming focused information once adequate space has been provided for the client's account. Open exploration and empathic reflection are generally better suited to discovering meaning and responding to emotional complexity.

Question 20 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Pause the advice and invite Malik to describe what happened for him as the group responded.

Explanation: The leader uses the here-and-now process by interrupting an unhelpful pattern and returning attention to Malik's immediate experience. More advice or a quick topic shift would bypass the withdrawal that is already occurring in the room.

Question 21 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Remain quietly attentive and allow the client space to continue when ready.

Explanation: The client is emotionally engaged, oriented, and beginning to regulate, so purposeful silence communicates presence without interrupting the grief process. Rapid questions or premature reassurance could shift the counselor away from the client's experience.

Question 22 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Help the client choose the request, role-play the conversation, and refine wording based on the client's feedback.

Explanation: Collaborative rehearsal builds skill, confidence, and ownership while keeping the client in control of the advocacy goal. Speaking for the client or imposing a fixed script would reduce autonomy and may not fit the client's voice or workplace context.

Question 23 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Use simple truthful language, describe current safety routines, practice a coping skill, and check what the child understood.

Explanation: Developmentally appropriate facts, predictable safety information, and practiced coping support a child's sense of security without overwhelming the child. Checking understanding also lets the adult correct frightening misconceptions rather than assuming the message was received.

Question 24 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: Explain the body's alarm response in plain language, then rehearse a brief grounding strategy and ask the student to describe its effect.

Explanation: This approach offers understandable information, provides immediate skills practice, and checks the intervention's effect. A handout alone does not establish comprehension or skill use, and telling the student to ignore sensations may feel invalidating and does not teach regulation.

Question 25 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Structure equal speaking turns and reflect the pursue-withdraw pattern occurring between the partners.

Explanation: Couples counseling is better served by slowing the exchange and making the interactional cycle visible than by adjudicating whose memory is correct. Written accounts would continue the fact-finding contest rather than change the pattern maintaining the conflict.

Question 26 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Collaborate on consistent sleep cues and stimulus-control practices that can flex with shifts and preserve valued family time.

Explanation: The core behavioral principles can be adapted to the client's actual schedule and values rather than applied as a rigid clock time. This preserves both feasibility and cultural responsiveness; abandoning the approach entirely is not required by rotating shifts.

Question 27 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: To integrate major themes, check shared understanding, and support continuity.

Explanation: A therapeutic summary organizes key material and gives the client a chance to confirm or correct the counselor's understanding. It is not intended to introduce unprocessed interpretations or reproduce every detail of the session.

Question 28 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Describe the observable change without assigning meaning and invite the client to clarify what is happening.

Explanation: A tentative observation respects the ambiguity of telehealth cues and opens space for the client's own explanation. Assuming avoidance may be inaccurate, while ignoring a marked change could miss important emotional or technical information.

Question 29 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Explore what the grandparent's involvement and the adolescent's privacy mean to each person, then negotiate roles and session boundaries.

Explanation: This response avoids assuming that either cultural tradition or individual privacy has a single fixed meaning for the family. Collaborative negotiation respects the adolescent's voice and the family's relational values without automatically privileging one over the other.

Question 30 — Correct: A

Correct Answer: “I appreciate you telling me. I may have been moving too quickly; can we look at when you felt cut off and what you needed from me?”

Explanation: This response accepts the feedback without defensiveness, acknowledges the counselor’s possible contribution, and invites specific information needed for repair. Explaining time limits before exploring the client’s experience would likely deepen the rupture.

Question 31 — Correct: B

Correct Answer: Use a calm voice, acknowledge the client’s overwhelm, and offer a choice between sitting or continuing to walk while talking.

Explanation: Calm validation and limited choices can reduce demands, restore some control, and support de-escalation. Detailed problem solving is less usable while arousal is high, and requiring a quieter voice as a condition may intensify the power struggle.

Question 32 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Explore the barriers and collaboratively choose one small, personally meaningful activity with a specific time.

Explanation: Behavioral activation is adjusted by reducing task difficulty, linking action to meaning, and making the step concrete. Reassigning an overwhelming list ignores the information gained from noncompletion, while one unsuccessful assignment does not establish that the whole approach is ineffective.

Question 33 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: Stop the imagery and use the agreed pause procedure to support present-moment orientation.

Explanation: The client’s sudden nonresponsiveness and disorientation indicate that the current exercise has exceeded the client’s capacity to remain engaged. Honoring the agreed pause and reorienting to the present is safer and more responsive than pressing forward or requesting interpretation during disconnection.

Question 34 — Correct: C

Correct Answer: “As we discuss this, I notice you look away each time I offer an observation. What is happening between us right now?”

Explanation: Immediacy focuses on the present interaction between counselor and client and invites exploration of what is occurring in the therapeutic relationship. The other statements address an outside event or future problem solving rather than the here-and-now relationship.
